

Flexi-transport



Exocar is a concept transportation unit that allows a user to travel in a more flexible manner using the four wheels which adapt to the body of the user



Cyclops in India

A remote surveillance system that offers recording capabilities called Cyclops was recently launched in India by World Phone Internet Services

Cover feature

7 Illogistics

Perhaps the largest scale problem we have, and the one which would require the largest investment yet, logistics is the problem that billions are spent on to save even more money in the long run. In India, the logistical challenges are nothing short of a nightmare. With no guarantee of finding a driveable road where one existed just a month ago, and where nothing seems to run on schedule, how this country manages to get things done on a daily basis is nothing short of a miracle.

Solution: Pipe-o-dreams

A lot of us would have seen the email forward that contains a PPT or video of the train that never stops at a station, supposedly conceptualised by a Taiwanese gentleman named Peng Yu-lun. The origins of the idea are under debate, but that's of little importance to us right this moment. What was obvious from this video is that an innovative idea can really revolutionise technologies we thought we had perfected. For over a century and a half, trains have stopped at stations to allow people to get on and off, and until 2007 no one really thought about all this stopping being unnecessary...

The pipe-o-dreams is an idea that may seem just as ridiculous at first, but feels more and more plausible the more you think about it, and envision the different ways it can be implemented, and the stuff you can achieve with it afterwards.

How it could work

The pipe-o-dreams could be a pipe, a conveyor belt, or a vacuum tube, with diameters ranging from a few inches to a few hundred feet – depending on what needs to be transported. This may sound like a solution for liquids only, such as crude oil and water – which is what most countries use such pipelines for – but we feel we're only limited by imagination here.

The ordinary

Let's assume we have a trans-India, pipe-o-dreams that carries water across India. This could be sea-water that's pumped to a treatment plant in drought affected areas in the interiors. Huge initial costs, sure, but we'd get salt, potable water, and increase

the green cover in areas where this would not normally be possible. We're never going to run short of sea water either, so it's sustainable forever. We'd need CAPP (our cheap and portable power solution) to keep pumping water through the pipeline, and reduce the operational costs involved in maintaining and running a thousand kilometre (or more) pipeline.

The extraordinary

Transporting water to areas that have little is desirable, but by no stretch of imagination will this solve our logistic problems. Now if we were to use this same pipeline to also transport goods that would normally be sent by road, you've got a logistics solution on your hands. As a random example, imagine a shipment of wheat that needs to be sent from Mumbai to Jaipur. The road or rail transport costs would scale up based on the size of the shipment. However, if we were to pack the wheat into specially made rubber balloons that could withstand the water pressure in our Mumbai-Jaipur arm of the pipe-o-dreams, we'd be able to pop them into the pipeline and let the water we're already sending to Jaipur carry the wheat there for us. This would probably be faster than road or rail, and we'd be able to just keep sending as much as we need, since the water supply would be continuous anyway. A few added precautions, and better packaging ideas, and we could send crude oil through the same pipeline.

Heck, when we sat about brainstorming this, there were even ideas that suggested all we need for the pipe-o-dreams to work was a better extraction process. Just create a slurry of food grain, water, oil and whatever else we needed to send, and just pump that along the pipe,

and leave the separation plant at the other end to do the work of extracting the different components of that slurry.

Must-clicks

<http://bit.ly/aOsGRO> | <http://bit.ly/yBIKL> | <http://bit.ly/9RAebX>

The new India

In a country where people are starving in some places, while in others a million tons of grain are rotting because of an excess crop that no one wants to buy, it's time people like us started dreaming up and working on some innovations that can change all of this. We've often heard of German efficiency, Japanese work ethics, and American grit. Perhaps it's time to show the world that India is ready to face its problems head on, and use good old Indian ingenuity to start a *Tech Kranti*.

Take one pipe-o-dreams, power it with the CAPP, add a generous helping of Cumulo-Indus, use the Babel-babble to communicate, a Me-Mo to transact, and you have a solution to most of India's problems.

As an interesting experiment of your own, stand in a public place, read that last sentence out aloud, and write in and tell us the reactions you got – if they ever let you out of the asylum, that is. 

